



Mentor Ankit Daftary is an independent maker and interaction designer who runs a company called Daf Labs in Bangalore

in Mumbai, Nuts and Boltz in Delhi, Collab House and Potential Labs in Hyderabad, Workbench Projects, The Workshop and Eden in Bangalore, and Maker Loft in Kolkata are some of the popular ones.

Here, you can walk into a makerspace and try your hand at it before you commit and put money down on sanders, lathes and rotary tools. If carpentry isn't worth wasting your wood, there's metal work, taking apart bikes, racing RC cars, building drones, and introduction to electronics through breadboards, Arduino, Raspberry Pi, etc. Oh yes, they also like breaking things. But not for nothing, education is a major role of the makerspace. But learning isn't put forth as a formal curriculum. Instead, it comes to you as a byproduct of building. There may be short courses and workshops led by community mentors who have earned their title by giving back to the space or because they are domain experts. These mentors will guide members through difficulties but for the most part, you are on your own. And for this reason, the maker movement is sometimes also called and confused for the DIY movement. It isn't wrong to call DIY enthusiast makers but it's more of a subset than an interchangeable term.

On a typical day at a makerspace, in addition to students trying to test theories they have learned in class practically, you will find hardware entrepreneurs trying to prototype their next product, dads teaching their sons to build a table from planks of wood, artistes trying to create art that responds